# Game Week

## Build a game people want to play

## Overview

Choose one of the genres below. The examples are inspiration, not games to recreate. Give your game its own identity, mechanics, and visual style.

| CENTRAL FOCUS | *Create a beautiful, unique, and clean game. Use this week to practice generating the visual and audio assets that give your game its own identity—not just making the mechanics work.* |
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## Schedule

| Milestone | When |
|---|---|
| **Game due** | Thursday @ Midnight |
| **Playing and judging** | Friday morning |
| **Winners announced** | Friday around lunch |

## The bar for every game

Your game should feel like a complete experience—not a tech demo or a single level.

- **Required design quality:** Your game must have polished, high-quality graphics and a cohesive visual style. Games with graphics that look thrown together, use mismatched styles, or are generally poor quality will fail the assignment.
- **Make it substantial:** Your game should have enough original, meaningful gameplay to feel like a complete experience—not a single mechanic, a simple clone, or a short demo stretched across multiple screens. Players should encounter varied challenges and a clear sense of progression. Repetition or cosmetic changes alone do not count as depth.
- **A clear objective:** Players know what they are trying to accomplish and how to play.

- **A beginning, middle, and end:** Include an introduction, meaningful progression, and a satisfying conclusion or result.
- **More than one moment of gameplay:** Players encounter new challenges, choices, or mechanics as they progress.
- **A unique, clean design:** Your game should be visually distinctive, polished, and cohesive. Its look, sound, and feel should reinforce its world and make the experience meaningful.
- **Playable by someone else:** A new player can get started without you standing beside them. Include brief instructions where needed.
- **Browser access:** Make your game playable in a web browser and provide a link others can use. Players should not need to install the game.
- **Finish the details:** Pay attention to layout, typography, animation, sound levels, and feedback. Avoid a collection of default or mismatched assets; the result should feel like one intentionally designed game.

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| **GENERATE ALL ASSETS** | *All assets must be generated for your game, including visuals and audio such as sprites, characters, environments, sound effects, and music. Do not use pre-made assets. Choose assets appropriate to your genre and make them feel like they belong together.* |

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| **POLISH OVER SIZE** | *A smaller, finished game is better than a larger, unfinished one.* |

## Choose Your Game

Pick one of the three options below. The table gives a quick comparison; each option is detailed in the sections that follow.

| Option | Inspiration | The goal | What makes it great |
|---|---|---|---|
| **1: Exploration / Adventure** | Ecco the Dolphin, The Legend of Zelda | Create a world that rewards players for exploring and gives them a reason to keep going. | The world feels like a place, not a collection of rooms. Exploration and discovery matter. |
| **2: Platformer** | Super Mario Bros., Celeste | Create a game where movement is satisfying and players develop mastery as they progress. | The controls feel good, the difficulty is intentional, and the game keeps finding interesting ways to use its mechanics. |

| Option | Inspiration | The goal | What makes it great |
|---|---|---|---|
| **3: Multiplayer Racing** | Mario Kart | Create a short, exciting racing game that people can play together and want to replay. | The racing feels good, it is easy to get into a match, and the experience is fun over repeated short sessions. |

## Option 1: Exploration / Adventure

**Inspiration:** Ecco the Dolphin, The Legend of Zelda

Create a world that rewards players for exploring and gives them a reason to keep going.

### Your game should include

- A clear central goal and a beginning-to-end story or journey.
- At least three distinct, connected areas that players can explore and revisit.
- At least three meaningful obstacles or puzzles that require more than simply finding the exit.
- A sense of progression: An ability, item, discovery, or change in the world opens a new path.
- A world with a consistent visual identity and an ending that resolves the central goal.
- Aim for a complete game that takes a new player roughly 10–15 minutes to finish, with genuinely distinct challenges along the way. This is a target, not a stopwatch-based pass/fail rule.

**What makes it great:** The world feels like a place, not a collection of rooms. Exploration and discovery matter to the experience.

## Option 2: Platformer

**Inspiration:** Super Mario Bros., Celeste

Create a game where movement is satisfying and players develop mastery as they progress.

### Your game should include

- Responsive movement and a core mechanic that remains fun throughout the game.
- At least three distinct stages or sections, connected by a clear progression.
- Increasing challenge: Introduce an obstacle or mechanic, then build on it.

- A reasonable retry system so players can learn from failure without excessive frustration.
- A final challenge and a clear ending. Build an entire game, not just a single level.
- Aim for a complete game that takes a new player roughly 10–15 minutes to finish, with genuinely distinct challenges along the way. This is a target, not a stopwatch-based pass/fail rule.

**What makes it great:** The controls feel good, the difficulty is intentional, and the game keeps finding interesting ways to use its mechanics.

## Option 3: Multiplayer Racing

**Inspiration:** Mario Kart

Create a short, exciting racing game that people can play together and want to replay.

### Your game should include

- At least two people racing together, with a clear way to join the same game.
- At least two distinct tracks or courses with different layouts or challenges.
- A complete race flow: start, race, finish, results, and a way to play again.
- Clear feedback on position or progress and who won.
- At least one mechanic beyond basic steering and acceleration, such as boosts, hazards, drifting, or power-ups.
- Multiplayer that works reliably enough for players to complete a race together.

Individual races can be short, but the game should offer enough variety and multiplayer polish to make people want to race again.

**What makes it great:** The racing feels good, it is easy to get into a match, and the experience is fun over repeated short sessions.